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Data Governance & Security: Enabling Data First Decision Making Without Sacrificing Compliance

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Meet the Speakers

Sean is a Principal in Wolf's DenSecure group, where he leads engagements across both offensive and defensive security. On the offensive side, he develops security reviews and manages projects, including security reviews, penetration tests, social engineering, threat emulation, and red teams. On the defensive side, Sean is responsible for the oversight and execution of virtual CISO (vCISO) consulting projects and digital forensic investigations.

Sean has over a decade of experience in consulting and has worked extensively in the financial, healthcare, education, and software sectors.

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Meet the Speakers

Philip is a Principal in Wolf's Data Solutions group, where he leads the implementation of value-driven data strategies and custom software development in the Wolf Data Solutions product line. Philip has two decades of experience building software and data systems across multiple industries.

Philip began his career leading and managing software development teams and operating personnel for a scalable algorithm-based pharmaceutical drug analysis program, designed to monitor and improve patient behavioral and medical health outcomes. Over the last decade, he has focused on building scalable data applications for mid-market, private equity-owned companies aiming to enhance their understanding and utilization of enterprise data.

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AGENDA

1. Intro & Context
2. Data-First Initiative
3. Frameworks
4. Security-Driven Governance
5. Closing Q&A

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Introduction and Context

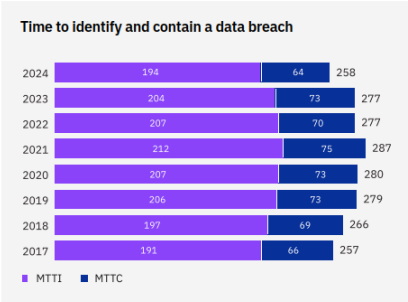

Figure 4. Measured in days

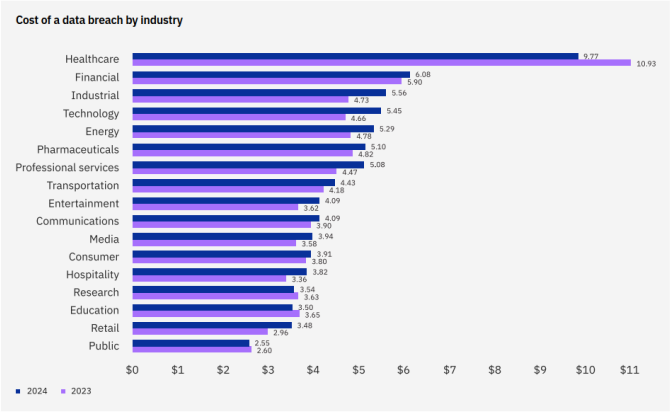

Figure 3. Measured in USD millions

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Good afternoon, everyone. I'm Sean Goodwin, Principal at Wolf & Company. Thanks for joining today's session on *Data Governance & Security*. This topic is increasingly critical for organizations, not because regulators are asking for more paperwork, but because operating a modern enterprise without secure, governed data has become impossible. Between rising cyber threats, fintech integrations, digital channels, cloud adoption, and new compliance expectations, data governance is now a security discipline first, and a data quality discipline second.

- https://verizon.com/dbir
- https://www.ibm.com/reports/data-breach

Key Threats from Recent Years

- Ransomware & Extortion
  - Ransomware present in 44% of breaches; median ransom paid dropped to $115,000, but 64% of victims refused to pay.
  - Ransomware downtime averages three weeks, even with backups
  - Extortion attacks (ransomware, data exfiltration, destructive) cost up to $5.68M on average.

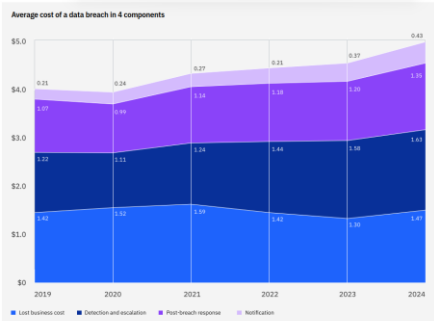

Figure 5. Measured in USD millions

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44% of breaches involve ransomware (https://www.verizon.com/business/resources/reports/dbir/).

Median ransom paid: **$115,000**;

64% of victims refuse payment (https://www.verizon.com/business/resources/reports/dbir/).

Downtime averages **3 weeks**, even with backups (https://www.wolfandco.com/resources/insights/).

Extortion-only attacks (data theft, harassment, DDoS) are on the rise.

Why Security-Led Governance Matters

- Organizations face rising cyber threats, regulatory expectations, and complex data ecosystems.
- Regulators emphasize that cybersecurity lapses can impact core processes and institutional safety.
- Cyber risk is increasingly an enterprise-level issue.

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Let's start with why this matters. Disruptions or unauthorized alteration of systems and information can directly affect a organization's financial condition and risk profile.

At the same time, industry analysis shows that cybersecurity has become one of the top enterprise risks, not just a technical concern.

So, the question isn't: Should we focus on data governance?
It's: How do we build a governance model *rooted* in security and regulatory expectations…one that scales with our business and keeps us safe while we modernize?

The Data-First Imperative

- M&A Activity, greenfield data implementations, digital transformation, fintech integration, and new channels create more data but also more risk.
- Fragmented systems, manual reconciliation, and legacy infrastructure hinder secure data-driven decisions.
  - High-risk integration periods increase exposure.

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Most orgs here are somewhere on a digital transformation path: implementing APIs, adding tech partners, moving to cloud services, and automating more internal operations.

But modernization increases risk during integration windows.

Public analysis shows that you are most exposed not when systems are steady, but when changes are underway and when old and new systems are interacting and controls temporarily fall behind.

So, the question becomes: If we want to make data-first decisions, how do we ensure that data is trustworthy across all these moving parts?

Data-First Initiatives

- Utilizing data for the development of new products and services
  - Cross-selling
  - Personalization
  - Machine Learning
  - Automated financial reporting and accounting
- Central Data Lakehouses for AI Consumption

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Data Warehousing Is Now a Security Control

- Centralized warehouses enforce:
  - Data classification
  - Row- and column-level security
  - Audit Trails
- Poor Warehouse design leads to:
  - Data Sprawl
  - Uncontrolled AI Access
  - Compliance Blind Spots

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AI-Ready Data Architecture

- AI / ML Workloads consuming on governed data outputs
- Monitoring & Audit layer spanning all tiers
- Implementation of off-the-shelf tools to manage enterprise data governance (i.e. Purview, Collibra)

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Governance Starts with Security

- GLBA mandates administrative, technical, and physical safeguards to protect customer data.
- Security controls must drive how data is classified, handled, accessed, retained, and disposed.

"focus will be on training and security controls that firms are employing to identify and mitigate new risks associated with artificial intelligence (AI) and polymorphic malware attacks, including how they are operationalizing information from threat intelligence sources"

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A key shift to embrace is this: Data governance begins with security.

The Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act is clear: organizations must implement administrative, technical, and physical safeguards to protect customer information.

GLBA's Privacy Rule and Safeguards Rule form the backbone of today's data governance obligations.

This isn't optional; federal law expects organizations to define how they classify, protect, access, retain, and destroy information. Understanding that helps reframe governance as a compliance-anchored discipline.

https://www.sec.gov/files/2026-exam-priorities.pdf

Anchor Governance to a Recognized Framework

- NIST CSF defines five essential functions: Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover.
- Updated CSF 2.0 integrates cybersecurity with enterprise risk management; ideal for data governance.
- SEC 2026 Exam Priorities call out AI specifically.
- Companies should align policies, controls, and governance committees directly to these functions.

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In practice, the cleanest way to build this is by anchoring your governance program to a nationally recognized framework and NIST CSF 2.0 is the most widely adopted.

NIST CSF breaks the world into
- Identify,
- Protect,
- Detect,
- Respond, and
- Recover

Functions that map directly to how data should be governed.

With CSF 2.0, NIST has strengthened the connection between cybersecurity and enterprise risk management.

That makes it ideal for organizations that must prove governance maturity to regulators, auditors, and boards.

https://www.sec.gov/files/2026-exam-priorities.pdf

SEC Examination Priorities

- "Particular attention will be on firms' policies and procedures pertaining to governance practices, data loss prevention, access controls, account management, and responses and recovery to cyber-related incidents, including those related to ransomware attacks."

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https://www.sec.gov/files/2026-exam-priorities.pdf

NIST AI 800-4: Challenges to the Monitoring of Deployed AI Systems

- Pre-Deployment Testing Is Necessary But Not Sufficient
  - **Functionality Monitoring:** Does the system continue to work as intended?
  - **Operational Monitoring:** Does the system maintain consistent service across its infrastructure?
  - **Human Factors Monitoring:** Is the system transparent to humans and producing high-quality outputs?
  - **Security Monitoring:** Is the system secure against attacks and misuse?
  - **Compliance Monitoring:** Does the system adhere to relevant regulations and directives?
  - **Large-Scale Impacts Monitoring:** Does the system promote human flourishing?

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- The center of gravity is shifting from pre-deployment to post-deployment.
- Monitoring is going to become a first-class infrastructure investment.
- The agent era makes everything harder.
- Compliance monitoring is going to collide with reality.
- Information sharing is the boring problem that determines everything.

See provided worksheet for detailed questions to consider for each of these areas in for environment

https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/ai/NIST.AI.800-4.pdf
https://andrewclearwater.substack.com/p/nist-just-told-us-whats-actually

NIST AI-800-4

NIST.AI.800-4.pdf

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Challenges to the monitoring of deployed AI systems: Center for AI Standards and Innovation

AWARE Framework

- Shift left.
  - Bake governance into design and development, not just for audits and after-the-fact checks.
- Govern agents like people.
  - Assign scoped permissions, unique identities, and real-time observability.
- Build security into the stack.
  - Securing AI means embedding controls natively across IAM, DLP, and MLOps so they operate as an integrated system and ensuring visibility through systems like SIEM, rather than treating security as a bolt-on added after deployment.
- Move beyond compliance.
  - Use behavior-aware enforcement with dynamic risk scoring of agents and automated remediation.

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https://www.glean.com/resources/guides/aware

AWARE Framework

- Authentication
  - Can you verify the identity behind an action? Many AI agents operate without a human actively interacting with it, making it hard to know who, or what, is responsible.
- Auditability
  - Can you trace what led the agent to act? Traditional logs might show an API call, but not the string of prompts and decisions behind it.
- Authorization
  - Did the agent have the right access? Many run on service accounts or inherited user credentials, often with overly broad permissions. Importantly though, authorization must go further than access rights. It should also confirm whether the agent was explicitly sanctioned to perform a specific action, not just technically permitted to do so

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AWARE Framework

Dimensions	Key Question	What's new
A — Actor Intent	Who or what is acting, and why?	Agents aren't static users. They change roles, scopes, and triggers.
W — Work Context	Is this data/action sensitive at this moment?	Sensitivity depends on context, not just labels.
A — Autonomous Guardrails	Does this match the agent's declared purpose?	Agents hallucinate, drift, and act out of scope.
R — Real-Time Risk Scoring & Blocking	How risky is this action right now?	Risk spikes based on action chains, context shifts, or abnormal triggers.
E — Ecosystem Observability	Can we trace actions across systems and time?	Agents operate, often invisibly, across apps, APIs, files, and cloud tools.

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5 Dimensions of AI Security:

Actor Intent - Who or what is acting, and why?
Work Context – Is this data or action sensitive *in this context?*
Autonomous Guardrails - Is this action/output within the agent's declared purpose and policy constraints?
Real-Time Risk Scoring & Blocking – How risky is this agent's behavior right now?
Ecosystem Observability – Can we trace and audit what the agent did across systems and over time?

https://www.glean.com/resources/guides/aware

AWARE Framework

Threat	Primary Risk	Key AWARE Dimension(s)	Example Mitigation
Prompt Injection / Jailbreaking	Agent override; data leakage; executing malicious instructions	A, A, R (Actor Intent, Autonomous Guardrails, Real-Time Risk Scoring)	Enforce declared scope; scan for jailbreak patterns; elevate risk score for suspicious prompts
RAG Leakage / Context Misuse	Oversharing contextually inappropriate information	W, R, E (Work Context, Real-Time Risk Scoring, Ecosystem Observability)	Apply real-time access rules; block out-of-pattern retrievals; log for audit and refinement
Agent Chaining / Cascading Failures	Compound errors or missteps across multi-agent workflows	R, E, A (Real-Time Risk Scoring, Ecosystem Observability, Autonomous Guardrails)	Treat chained workflows as higher risk; trace sequences; apply guardrails at each step
Silent Drift / Scope Creep	Agents evolve beyond original purpose or access level	A, R, E (Actor Intent, Real-Time Risk Scoring, Ecosystem Observability)	Require re-approval for changes; flag behavioral deviations; audit config and behavior drift
Embedding Leakage / Model Inversion	Exposure of sensitive data via vector search or model memory	W, E, A (Work Context, Ecosystem Observability, Autonomous Guardrails)	Block high-risk embeddings; detect inversion patterns; filter sensitive outputs

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Prompt injection and jailbreaking Example

Threat
Attackers manipulate an agent's input—either directly (e.g., "Ignore prior instructions") or indirectly (hidden commands in documents or chats)—to hijack its behavior. This can override safeguards and trick the AI into leaking data, executing malicious tasks, or breaking policy. Anthropic's research highlights that prompt injection attacks are a major security challenge for browser-based AI agents, where malicious content can hijack an agent's behavior by embedding hidden instructions in the content it processes.

Risk
Agents may execute commands outside their intended scope.
Sensitive data can be exposed unintentionally.
These attacks exploit the model's functionality—not its code—making them hard to detect with traditional security tools.

AWARE-based mitigations
A — Actor Intent

Agents are bound to a declared purpose (e.g., “summarize docs”). If a prompt falls outside that purpose (e.g., requesting data exfiltration), the agent is designed to reject the request and stay within scope.

W — Work Context
n/a

A — Autonomous Guardrails
Prompts and outputs are scanned for known jailbreak patterns, suspicious tokens, or policy-violating behavior. If detected, the system blocks execution or redacts the output.

R — Real-Time Risk Scoring & Blocking
If an agent session encounters suspicious prompts (e.g., “ignore all prior instructions”), the system elevates its risk score. High-risk sessions trigger containment measures like throttling, sandboxing, or escalating to human-in-the-loop review.

E — Ecosystem Observability
Platforms should log not only prompts and outputs but also mitigation actions taken, to provide audit trails that validate vendor-side security intervention.

AWARE Framework

Aware-whitepaper-2026.pdf

2026_VCPEIT_AI Monitoring Worksheet.pdf

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https://www.glean.com/resources/guides/aware

Securing the Data Supply Chain

- Modern ecosystems include APIs, tech partners, cloud, and legacy systems.
- Increased integration = increased attack surface (especially during key vendor transitions).
- Governance must include:
  - Vendor segmentation
  - Least-privilege partner access
  - Continuous monitoring of partner activity
  - Pre-integration security assessments

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Companies today operate in large interconnected ecosystems
- APIs,
- Tech partners,
- cloud providers,
- key vendors.

Public analysis shows that these integrations create dual risk: new digital endpoints and old weaknesses in legacy systems.

Good governance must include:
- vendor segmentation,
- least privilege access for partners,
- continuous monitoring of third-party activity, and
- mandatory pre-integration security reviews.

If your data supply chain isn't governed, your internal governance is meaningless.

Zero Trust as a Governance Backbone

- SEC guidance stresses preventing unauthorized alteration of information and systems.
- Zero Trust principles enforce continuous validation, micro-segmentation, and identity-driven access.
- Perfect model for organizations modernizing or expanding digital channels.

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Zero Trust is not a buzzword; it's a governance model.

The SEC highlights the need to prevent unauthorized alteration of information and systems.

Zero Trust brings that to life through continuous identity validation, segmentation, and strong authentication.

For companies modernizing technology, Zero Trust becomes essential because it assumes compromise and focuses on limiting the blast radius.

Privacy, Ethics & Regulatory Alignment

- GLBA governs privacy and security of customer financial information.
- Emerging AI governance intersects with data privacy, model transparency, and auditability (NIST's AI profile work).
- Companies must ensure transparent data usage, minimize bias, and maintain decision traceability.

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We're now living in an era where privacy and AI governance overlap with cybersecurity.

GLBA defines core data privacy and protection requirements.

Meanwhile, NIST is actively publishing guidance on AI governance, risk management, and transparency; all of which affect how data must be governed.

As AI adoption grows, organizations will need governance structures that ensure fairness, explainability, and auditability.

Incident Response & Resilience

- NIST emphasizes frequent tabletop testing and readiness exercises.
- SEC outlines requirements for incident notification and structured response programs.
- Governance must ensure recovery point objectives (RPO) and recovery time objectives (RTO) align with business needs.

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Both SEC and NIST emphasize resilience: the ability to respond and recover from cyber incidents.

This includes tabletop exercises, communication protocols, escalation procedures, and evidence logs for regulators. SEC guidance reinforces mandatory notification processes for significant incidents involving covered systems or third-party service providers.

Board-Level Reporting & Oversight

- GLBA requires boards to approve and oversee security programs.
- SEC expects governance structures to integrate cyber and data risk into enterprise risk management.
- Recommended:
  - Quarterly governance dashboards
  - Maturity metrics aligned to NIST CSF
  - Framework compliance reporting

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The GLBA Safeguards Rule places responsibility for the information security program at the board level.

SEC expects orgs to integrate cyber and data risks into enterprise risk frameworks and maintain strong oversight mechanisms.

Boards should be reviewing:
- NIST CSF maturity scoring,
- FFIEC assessment results,
- incident trends,
- remediation KPIs,
- and third-party risk posture.

Reporting Automation

- To streamline the governance program and ensure that adherence is met, report automation can be developed to remove the legwork needed for preparing materials:
- Some Examples
  - Pull data from IAM, SIEM, Cloud Platforms, Ticketing/IR Systems, Third-party Risk Platforms
  - Normalize the data
  - Map data to controls (NIST/ISO)/Assets
  - Compute -> Control Effectiveness, Gaps, Trends over time

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Roadmap for Implementation

- Phase 1: Foundation (0–90 days)
  - Map data assets and flows (NIST Identify).
  - Define classification schema & ownership.
  - Establish baseline controls & gaps using SEC resources.
- Phase 2: Hardening (90–180 days)
  - Implement access governance & Zero Trust principles.
  - Formalize patch & vulnerability management practices per SEC guidance.
  - Stand up integrated IR + data recovery processes.

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Here's a practical 180-day roadmap you can use.

- 0–90 Days: Establish the Foundation
  - Identify and classify all data and systems (NIST Identify).
  - Map data flows and ownership.
  - Review controls using SEC resources and NIST CSF.
- 90–180 Days: Harden & Operationalize
  - Implement Zero Trust principles.
  - Formalize vulnerability and patch management aligned to SEC expectations.
  - Stand up an integrated incident response and data recovery program.

Key Takeaways

- Security is the foundation, not a sub-discipline, of effective data governance.
- Regulators (SEC, GLBA, NIST) already provide a strong roadmap… companies simply need to align.
- Zero Trust, framework adoption, and third-party controls should anchor every company's 2026 strategy.
- Evolving guidance (including non-authoritative) will be key to keeping pace

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To close out:

Security must be the foundation of your data governance.

NIST CSF 2.0, SEC guidance, and GLBA form a ready-made roadmap.

Zero Trust, third-party governance, and strong operational controls are now mandatory, not optional.

And most importantly, governance is not a documentation exercise; it's the framework that enables safe, fast, data-driven decision making.

Thank you all. Happy to take questions.

Final Thoughts

- Security enables data.
- Data enables analytics.
- Analytics enables AI.
- Governance ties it all together.

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Thank You

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Our Services

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- Internal Audit Department Optimization
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- Three Lines of Defense Framework

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Gap analysis, risk assessment or specific testing over actual loan files, providing a trend analysis of results.

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- Threat emulation/blue team exercises using MITRE ATT&CK®
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- Digital Forensics

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- Consultation on income tax accounting methods
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DENSECURE

Who We Are

DenSecure is a team of advanced cyber experts, safeguarding your organization with hands-on, industry-specific testing. We identify gaps in your cybersecurity defenses before attackers can find and exploit them

What We Do

- Provide insights into how bad actors target your business & tactics to avoid a breach
- Strategic security recommendations for individual and holistic issues
- One-on-one, direct access to our in-house penetration testers

Services We Offer

- Digital Forensics
- Penetration Testing
- Red Team Assessment
- Social Engineering
- Threat Emulation
- vCISO

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DATA SOLUTIONS

Who We Are

Wolf's Data Solutions team, our in-house data science experts, develop robust data strategies so your organization can gain a competitive edge. We build a solid data foundation based on strong governance frameworks and optimize storage and retrieval processes. Our focus on identifying hidden patterns allows your organization to back your decisions with data you can trust.

What We Do

- Analyze your data & present the insights in an easy-to-read, accessible dashboard & collaborate with you to develop a strategic plan
- Manage your full data lifecycle by building centralized data warehouses to identify & incorporate insights into your business

Services We Offer

Data Strategy & Consulting

Data Integration & Management

Data Visualization

Data Infrastructure

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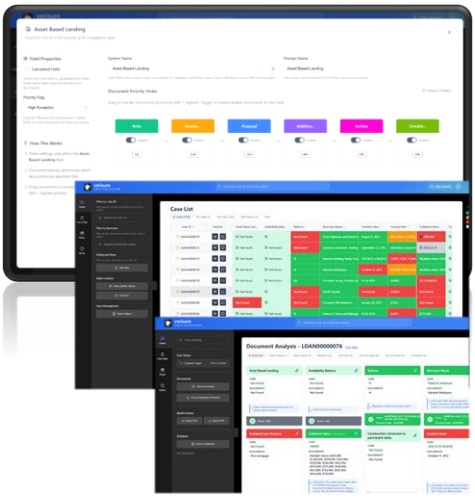
VERISURE

Agentic AI Powered Audit & Compliance Automation

- Verisure is a native AI solution designed to transform internal audit and loan processing workflows. By leveraging advanced AI and OCR technology, it eliminates manual effort, improves data accuracy, and accelerates compliance review.
- **AI-Driven Automation:** Reduce manual work in audits and compliance with intelligent document mapping and automated checks.
- **OCR Without Templates:** Extract data from any historical file format using AI-powered OCR—no brittle templates required.
- **Banking-Tuned Intelligence:** Automatically match paper documents to system values with rules-based prioritization for adjustments and modifications.
- **Enhanced Data Quality:** Improve accuracy during quality control and reconciliation processes.
- **Role-Based Collaboration:** Manage workflows across teams with secure, permission-based access.



WOLFPAC INTEGRATED RISK MANAGEMNENT®

WolfPAC Integrated Risk Management helps banks & credit unions build a modern, scalable enterprise risk management (ERM) program.

WolfPAC Pro™

The modular risk management platform used by hundreds of institutions for more than a decade:

- Bring consistency to your risk management program without the hassle of GRC systems
- Leave spreadsheet-based risk assessments behind for good
- Save time & money by increasing efficiency

WolfPAC Essentials™

The streamlined solution designed for use by smaller institutions:

- Business Continuity planning
- Information Technology Risk management
- Third-party (vendor) Risk management
- No implementation fees

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INSIGHTOUT

A Data-Driven Platform

InsightOut is an end-to-end. Data management platform that transforms complex data into easy-to-understand reports. With its advanced data validation, collection, and exploration capabilities, InsightOut ensures that your data-driven insights are both accurate and consistent. By utilizing this platform, your business can make informed decisions based on data you can trust.

What It Does

- Aggregates disparate data from systems across sales, finance, human resources &beyond
- Organizes & contextualizes data to enable you to better understand, control& distribute

Services We Offer

Data Consolidation

Data Management

Data Intelligence

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